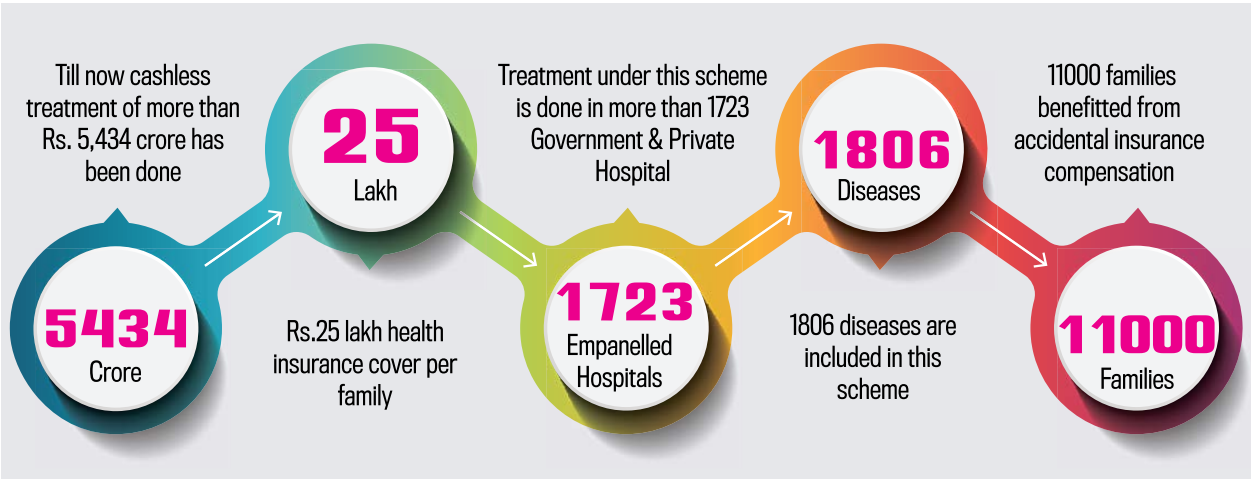


years. Rajasthan has now surpassed Kerala in terms of medical and health achievements, securing the top position from a previous 23rd rank in the country.

BREAKING BARRIERS

THE CHIEF MINISTER CHIRANJEEVI HEALTH INSURANCE SCHEME'S JOURNEY TOWARDS INCLUSIVE HEALTHCARE

Launched on May 1, 2021(Labour Day), the Chief Minister Chiranjeevi Health Insurance Scheme ensures universal health coverage, leaving no one excluded. Till now more than 45 lakhs patients have been benefitted from this scheme. The state government bears health insurance premiums for National Food Security Act beneficiaries, those eligible under Socio Economic Caste Census (SECC), contract workers across departments, small farmers, and families receiving Covid-19 ex-gratia. Recently, the government extended coverage to economically weaker section (EWS) families earning less than Rs 8 lakh annually. For these families, an additional budget provision of Rs 425 crore was made. Others pay 50% of the premium, which is Rs 850 per year per family. This scheme facilitates various transplants including lung, bone marrow, kidney, liver, and heart in empaneled hospitals. Moreover, the scheme now allows organ transplants even outside the state, reimbursing costs up to the package limit, effective from April 1, 2023.

EXPANDING HORIZONS

THE EVER-GROWING IMPACT OF THE CHIRANJEEVI SCHEME ON HEALTHCARE IN RAJASTHAN

Chief Minister Gehlot is actively expanding the Chiranjeevi Scheme's scope. It is being contemplated to include cochlear implants and insulin pumps for Type-I diabetes patients within the package. The scheme has become a lifeline for patients requiring heart surgeries, cochlear implants, cancer treatments, thalassemia, and haemophilia.

The scheme has transformed the lives of economically disadvantaged patients who couldn't afford expensive treatments. Over 10.33 lakh patients benefited from the scheme between May 1, 2021, and March 31, 2022, with expenses reaching Rs 1175 crore. From April 1, 2022, to June 30, 2023, more than 35.31 lakh patients received treatment under the scheme, costing Rs 3149 crore.

The National Health Authority (NHA) CEO, Ram Sevak Sharma, declared the Chiranjeevi Scheme an excellent initiative. This recognition sparked discussions across the country about the scheme's impact.

Among the beneficiaries, Antima, a 19-year-old from Jaipur, has been battling lung cancer for two years, receiving Rs 7 lakh worth of treatment covered entirely by the Chiranjeevi Scheme. Similarly, Mohan Lal Meena from Ramsinghpura underwent kidney transplant worth over Rs 30 lakh, all covered by the scheme. Mohan Lal expressed gratitude for not having to sell his assets to afford treatment, highlighting the scheme's life-changing impact.

The Chiranjeevi Scheme even aids road accident victims, ensuring free treatment in government or private hospitals for 72 hours. Even non-eligible victims receive free treatment during the initial 72 hours, after which they're referred to government hospitals or can opt for private treatment at their expense. This swift treatment protocol has proven instrumental in saving lives.

In Chief Minister Gehlot's words: "It's heartening to witness the positive impact of the Chiranjeevi Health Insurance Scheme. Numerous individuals are recovering through this initiative, and it brings joy to us all. Lakhs are availing free treatment under this scheme, and Rajasthan ranks at the forefront of health insurance coverage in the country due to this initiative."

